СКРИПТ АУДИРОВАНИЯ ТЕСТ. ДЗ ПРО №5

Вопрос №1-7

Interviewer: Good afternoon, everybody, and welcome to our program. Today we continue our series of programs about modern writers. We all love reading books, but at some point of our lives we all feel that we can write a best-seller or that an episode of our lives can become a plot for one. That's why you like our program so much, don't you? Well, in our studio right now we have Alex Smith, the famous writer. Good afternoon, Alex.

Alex Smith: Good afternoon. It's so nice being here. Thank you for inviting me.

Interviewer: Let me remind the listeners about your outstanding achievements, Alex. As far as I remember, you've written over 60 books for adults and children as well as a variety of academic legal texts. The best-known books you've written refer to the series about a lady's detective agency. The latest addition to this series was published in 2018. Am I correct?

Alex Smith: Absolutely.

Interviewer: Well, to start with, I address all the writers I talk to one and the same question: Why do you write?

Alex Smith: Like most writers, I write because I feel that I have to. It's not exactly a compulsion, but it's quite close to that. Writing makes sense of my world, which is what most of us want to do on some level or other. Earning money is important, but most writers would still write even if they weren't paid for that.

Interviewer: Which novelists do you admire?

Alex Smith: I like the usual ones: the great 19th-century novelists such as Tolstoy, Flaubert, and Dickens. However, I very much enjoy reading 20th-century and contemporary novels too. R. K. Narayan, the Indian writer who created a wonderful series of books set in a small Indian town of Malgudi, is one of my great literary heroes. He is something of a miniaturist, as is Barbara Pym, another enthusiasm of mine. Then for a bit of humor, I greatly admire E. F. Benson.

Interviewer: Will you please describe the route to your first novel being published?

Alex Smith: I started as a writer of children's books. I entered a writing competition and was fortunate enough to be one of the winners. After writing numerous children's books, I started to write short stories and then progressed to writing novels.

Interviewer: As far as I know, you have a literary agent. Has it helped you?

Alex Smith: At a very early stage in my writing career I acquired an agent. I was very fortunate to have Gina Green on my side and she continued to represent me until her retirement. I then went to Caroline Walsh, who has done a wonderful job for me. A good agent is above the price of rubies.

Interviewer: In what ways do you service your books?

Alex Smith: If you're fortunate enough to have your books taken up in a significant way, there is a tremendous amount to do in servicing the books. I do a lot of traveling and often attend literary festivals and other events all over the world. Although it can be quite burdensome, it is always very interesting to meet the readers, and I think that is what keeps me going.

Interviewer: What advice would you give to an aspiring novelist?

Alex Smith: I think that many novelists at the beginning of their careers spend far too much time writing and then tinkering with their first book. My advice is to write a book and then immediately go on to the next one and to the one after that. In other words, the more you write, the better you will become.

Interviewer: Thank you very much, Alex. It has been very interesting talking to you.

Alex Smith: My pleasure. I will be happy to come again one more time if you wish.